SHAKSHUKA

A rich, spicy tomato, garlic and onion sauce. Traditionally made with poached eggs. We will be creating a vegan dish with tofu. It is eaten for breakfast or any meal of the day. It's made from simple, healthy ingredients. Our first Shakshuka was in Israel, and to this day, it is still the best we have ever had. This is a family favorite amongst the Sandler's (a la Noah).

Origin

Shakshuka originated in North Africa, most likely in the region of Tunisia and the Maghreb, with a name derived from local Amazigh (Berber) and Arabic words meaning "all mixed up". The dish could only develop after tomatoes and chili peppers arrived in North Africa from the Americas via global trade in the 16th century.

Spread to the Middle East: North African Jewish immigrants brought the recipe to Israel in the 1950s, where it grew into a massive national staple

At a Glance

- **Prep Time:** Estimated time, 20 minutes
- **Cook Time:** Estimated time, 35-40 minutes
- **Servings:** Number of servings, 6-8

Preparation – *Mis en place* –*Everything in its place*

Tasks to complete before the main cooking begins to ensure a smooth process.

- **Chop/Dice:** mince garlic, and onions cut long way/vertically (called "pole-to-pole").
- **Assemble Tools:** wrought iron pan preferred but can use any nonstick deep pan

Ingredients

Primary Plant Protein/Base:

- 1 block medium firm tofu (cut in medium cubes) or 6-8 eggs

Fresh Produce & Aromatics:

- 1 large onion
- 4 gloves garlic

Pantry Staples & Seasonings:

- 2 cans tomato sauce
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 tbs sweet paprika
- 1 tbs spicy paprika
- 1 tsp cumin
- ½ tsp chili powder
- 2 tbs olive oil

Garnishes/Toppings: ○ ¼ cup chopped parsley

🔪 Directions

Clear, sequential steps to guide the cooking process. Cook in "layers"

Prepare

- mince garlic
- cut onion - cut long way/vertically (called "pole-to-pole")

Sauté

- Add 2 tbs of olive oil to the pan
- Add onions and cook for about 5 minutes
- Add garlic and the rest of the spices. Until nice and fragrant. cook halfway, then add garlic
- Add 2 cans of tomato sauce
- Bring the sauce to a simmer for about 15 mins
- Taste and season with more salt and pepper as needed
- Use a large spoon to make small wells in the sauce and crack the eggs into each well. Cook the eggs until they are done to your liking – typically about 15 mins so that it isn't too runny, looking for a poached consistency. OR if making with tofu, simply add the cubes to the sauce.
- You can also cover the pan with a lid to expedite the eggs cooking.

Serve: **small bowls and sprinkle with chopped parsley.**

💡 Quick Tips

Bonus advice for variations, efficiency, and sustainability.

- **Flavor Boost:** add spicier paprika for more of a kick
- **Substitution:** can add spinach, eggplant and/or peppers to the sauce
- **Meal Prep Hack:** Can store for a few days in refrigerator but best eaten fresh.

Nutritional Information

Estimated values

Egg	Per egg, contains approx. 75 cal, 6 g protein, 5 g fat. They provide a complete source of protein containing all nine essential amino acids
Tofu	90-144 calories per 100g, 10-14 g protein, 7 g fiber, 2g low carbs, Fat - heart-healthy polyunsaturated fat, 0 cholesterol. Includes calcium, manganese, iron, copper, selenium, phosphorus, magnesium, zinc and vitamins A, B1, B2 and B5
Tomato sauce	Per 1-cup, 60 cal, 13g carbs, 3g protein Exceptional source of the powerful antioxidant lycopene, as well as essential vitamins like Vitamin E and Vitamin C
Onion	38 cal, 0.8 gm, protein, 8.6 gm carbs, 1.9 gm, fiber, 0.1 grams fat Significant health benefits due to their rich antioxidants (like quercetin) and prebiotic fibers, supporting gut health, heart health by lowering cholesterol and blood pressure
garlic	Per 1 clove, 4.5 cal, 1 g of carbs, and virtually no fat While the nutrient amounts per single clove are small, garlic contains a high concentration of therapeutic sulfur compounds like allicin, which is responsible for most of its health benefits

Are eggs good for you?

Eggs are excellent for most people because they deliver a massive amount of essential nutrients for very few calories. While they were once feared for their cholesterol content, modern nutrition science shows that for most people, the dietary cholesterol in eggs has a minimal impact on blood cholesterol levels compared to saturated and trans fats

What is tofu and is it good for you?

Tofu is a nutrient-dense, plant-based protein made from curdled soy milk pressed into blocks, offering a complete amino acid profile, high iron, and calcium. It is generally considered very healthy, supporting heart health, reducing risk of certain cancers, and aiding weight management. It is low-fat, cholesterol free, and safe for daily consumption.

Tofu is highly nutritious and an excellent health food. It is low in calories, contains zero cholesterol, and serves as a complete plant-based protein because it delivers all nine essential amino acids your body cannot make on its own. Its nutritional profile varies primarily by its firmness; firmer varieties generally contain more protein, fat, and calories per serving because they have less water content.

- **Extra-Firm Tofu:** provides 15-17 g of protein, and 145 calories
- **Firm Tofu:** provides 8–10g of protein and 70-80 calories
- **Silken/Soft Tofu:** Higher in water content, providing about 4–7g of protein and 40–62 calories

Key Health Benefits

- **Heart Health:** Tofu is cholesterol-free, low in saturated fat, and may help reduce LDL cholesterol. Studies show eating at least one serving per week may lower heart disease risk by 18%.
- **Nutrient-Rich:** It is a good source of iron, manganese, selenium, phosphorus, and calcium, especially when made with calcium-sulfate.
- **Cancer Risk Reduction:** Tofu contains isoflavones, which have antioxidants, anti-inflammatory, and potential protective effects against breast, prostate, and colorectal cancers.
- **Bone Health:** The high calcium and magnesium content helps prevent osteoporosis.

Are soy products good for you?

Yes, soy products are generally considered very good for you, offering a nutrient-dense, plant-based protein source that can lower cholesterol and reduce heart disease risk. Whole soy foods like tofu, edamame, and tempeh are packed with isoflavones and fiber, making them a healthy alternative to red meat.